

Permit Utilization & Conservation Hunters Afield

This supplement answers two separate questions: whether published permit counts equal hunters afield, and how conservation permits should be represented without inflating the official 2025 hunter count.

PERMITS ISSUED DO NOT AUTOMATICALLY EQUAL HUNTERS AFIELD

Yes, the 2025 harvest report was completed to the current DWR dashboard coverage used by the library: 1,141 hunt-code rows across eight species. On the 1,130 rows where both fields are published, permits equal hunters afield on 656 rows and permits exceed hunters afield on 474 rows. No complete row has hunters afield greater than permits.

Across all retained rows, the published columns sum to 164,240 permits and 143,418 hunters afield, a difference of 20,822. That is 87.3% hunters afield per listed permit. Eleven rows have no hunters-afield value and one row has no permit value, so these sums are hunt-row references rather than a substitute for DWR statewide estimates.

DWR requires a harvest report from a big-game permit holder even when the permit holder did not hunt or harvest. That reporting design is why 'permit' and 'hunter afield' are different fields. Hunters afield should come from the official harvest record, not from adding issued, auctioned, or transferred permits.

Official references: <https://wildlife.utah.gov/biggame/reports> | <https://wildlife.utah.gov/harvest>

All 2025 big-game rows by species

Species	Hunt rows	Permits	Hunters afield	Permit-hunter gap	Afield / permits	Harvest
Bison	18	176	170	6	96.6%	141
Deer	421	85,857	74,532	11,325	86.8%	29,396
Desert Bighorn Sheep	25	99	99	0	100.0%	87
Elk	471	74,349	65,208	9,141	87.7%	16,381
Moose	43	204	202	2	99.0%	188
Mountain Goat	18	111	109	2	98.2%	98
Pronghorn	124	3,378	3,034	344	89.8%	2,221
Rocky Mountain Bighorn Sheep	21	66	64	2	97.0%	62
TOTAL	1,141	164,240	143,418	20,822	87.3%	48,574

The permit-hunter gap is not assumed to be nonparticipation in every case; dashboard values are report/survey outputs and some hunt programs are estimated differently. The correct use is to compare the two published fields, not to replace one with the other.

Completeness note: 11 of 1,141 rows have no hunters-afield value and 1 row has no permit value. The existing 2025 library report includes all 1,141 current dashboard rows. Its elk-age and deer-ratio context remains the latest verified 2024 annual management report because a complete 2025 age/ratio annual report was not available at build time.

Official 2025 conservation-class harvest rows

These 18 rows are the only rows in the current 2025 big-game harvest set explicitly labeled Hunt Type = Conservation. They are the source-backed conservation hunters-afield value: 31 permits, 28 hunters afield, and 24 harvested animals. Do not add the full conservation allocation list to these hunter totals.

Species	Hunt code	Hunt name	Weapon	Permits	Hunters afield	Harvest	Afield / permits	Success
Deer	DB1056	Book Cliffs	ALW	2	2	1	100.0%	50.0%
Desert Bighorn	DS1002	Kaiparowits, East	ALW	1	1	1	100.0%	100.0%
Desert Bighorn	DS1003	Kaiparowits, Escalante	ALW	1	1	1	100.0%	100.0%
Desert Bighorn	DS1004	San Rafael, Dirty Devil	ALW	1	1	1	100.0%	100.0%
Desert Bighorn	DS1006	Kaiparowits, West	ALW	1	1	1	100.0%	100.0%
Desert Bighorn	DS1007	San Rafael, South	ALW	1	1	1	100.0%	100.0%
Elk	EA1180	La Sal	ALW	2	2	2	100.0%	100.0%
Elk	EA1270	Manti	ALW	4	4	3	100.0%	75.0%
Elk	EA1271	Fishlake	ALW	3	3	3	100.0%	100.0%
Elk	EA2041	Cache	ALW	2	0	0	0.0%	-
Elk	EA2042	Fishlake Thousand Lakes	ALW	2	2	1	100.0%	50.0%
Elk	EA2045	Wasatch Mtns (Conservation)	ALW	4	4	3	100.0%	75.0%
Elk	EB3128	Box Elder, Grouse Creek	ALW	2	1	1	50.0%	100.0%
Elk	EB3209	Box Elder, Pilot Mtn	Multiseason	1	1	1	100.0%	100.0%
Rocky Mtn Bighorn	RS1000	Antelope Island	ALW	1	1	1	100.0%	100.0%
Rocky Mtn Bighorn	RS1001	Book Cliffs, South	ALW	1	1	1	100.0%	100.0%
Rocky Mtn Bighorn	RS1003	Box Elder, Newfoundland Mtn	ALW	1	1	1	100.0%	100.0%
Rocky Mtn Bighorn	RS1006	Nine Mile, Gray Canyon	ALW	1	1	1	100.0%	100.0%
TOTAL				31	28	24	90.3%	85.7%

A conservation permit can be sold and issued but still not appear as an additional hunter afield on the same public hunt-code row. Some permits have their own conservation hunt code; some area/condition permits cover multiple compatible codes; and an issued permit is not proof the recipient hunted. The DWR harvest row remains authoritative for hunters afield.

Conservation auction allocation context

The DWR 2025-27 conservation list contains 336 permits per year. The reviewed UOGA crosswalk groups them into 271 species/area/condition records and displays their coverage on 418 eligible hunt codes. Where one permit covers several hunt codes, the companion 2026 comprehensive permit register deliberately lists it on every compatible code.

Species	Annual conservation permits	Area/condition records	Hunt codes showing coverage
Antlerless Elk	20	13	5
Bear	44	31	100
Bison	6	6	19
Deer	39	36	43
Desert Bighorn Sheep	8	8	16
Elk	91	88	136
Moose	5	5	5
Mountain Goat	7	7	10
Pronghorn	69	53	58
Rocky Mountain Bighorn Sheep	6	6	13
Turkey	41	18	13
TOTAL	336	271	418 unique

Non-additive warning: repeating a multi-code conservation permit on each compatible code creates 1,454 visible code assignments from 336 unduplicated annual permits. That repeated number is a search aid, not a permit total and not a hunters-a-field total.

The DWR publishes both the multi-year permit list and a separate 2025 successful-bids report. The bids report identifies the organization, species, description, hunt/weapon, and winning bid. It establishes that a permit was auctioned; it does not establish that the successful bidder ultimately hunted.

Official conservation program and bid sources: <https://wildlife.utah.gov/conservationpermits> | https://wildlife.utah.gov/pdf/conservation-permits/2025_conservation_permit_bids.pdf

Recommended reading: use the 2025 harvest supplement for actual reported permits/hunters/harvest; use the comprehensive 2026 permit register for per-code availability and conservation coverage; use the existing Draw + EXPO reconciliation for the 26 exact codes whose public draw plus EXPO permits balance to Hunt Planner totals.